



şifr (*n., arabic*) — zero; the void; the origin of mathematics.

cipher (*n., cryptography*) — a code; a way of encoding meaning.

cypher (*n., music*) — a circle of voices in sequence.

cyph (*n.*) — the new underground for ideas.

founders

jalen daniels

in

- philosopher
- technologist
- strategist



role

strategy lead

alma mater

harvard

previous work

ex-mckinsey



researching

transhumanism · nietzsche · urban agriculture

bryan cash

in

- computer scientist
- sports savant
- optimizer



role

technology lead

alma mater

syracuse

previous work

ex-washington post



researching

technofeudalism · neuroathletics · socratic methodology



bakari kitwana

ex-eic of the source magazine



caitlin begg

ceo of authentic social and return to analog podcast

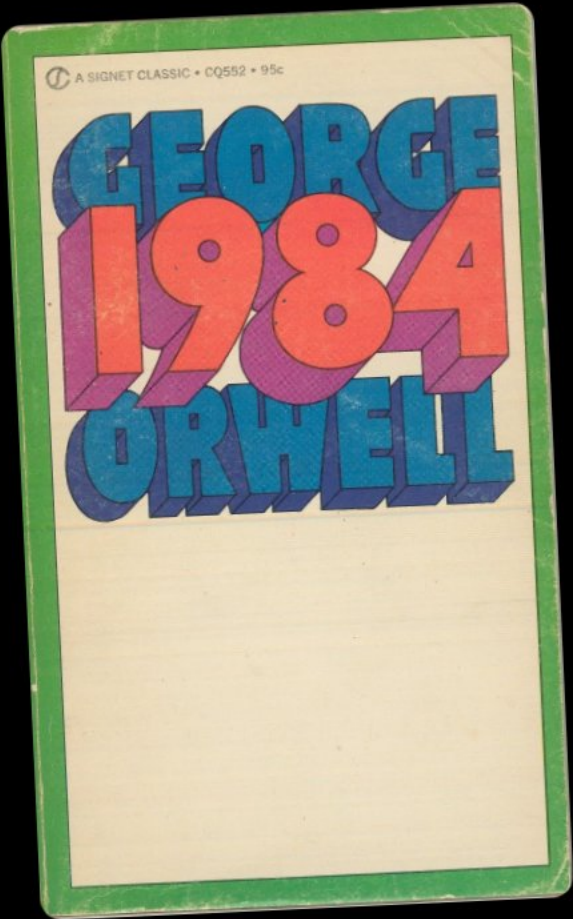
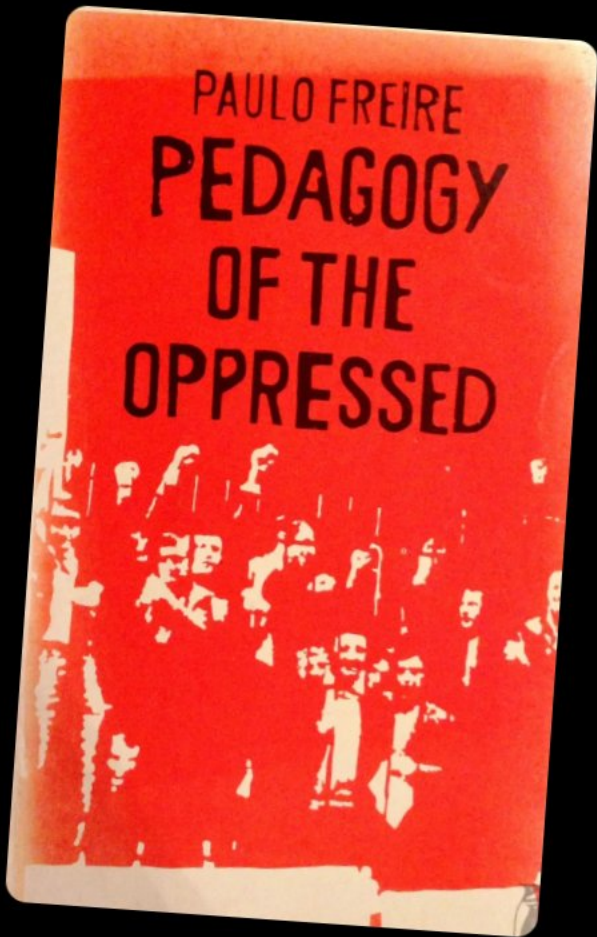
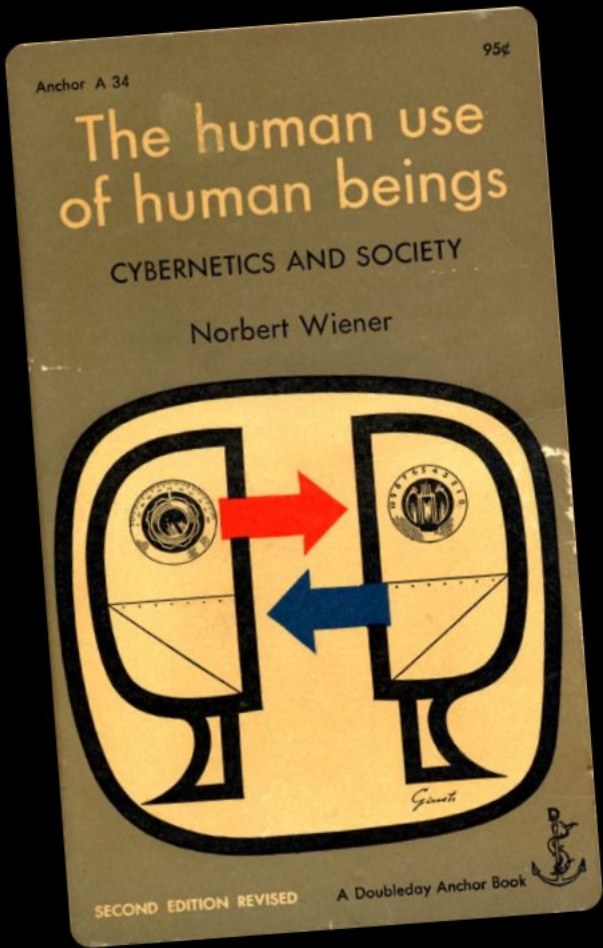
advisory board



calvary rogers

ex-google, founder of seneca labs

we're in a crisis.



ai = cognitive resignation

"your brain on chatgpt: accumulation of cognitive debt"



'veritas' is performative

"college professors say their academic freedom is in decline"



"safety" = mass surveillance

"homeland security subpoenas ice critics online"



[see our weekly pulse check here.](#)

but crisis always sparks counter culture.



the agora

athens, 500 bc

where free thought had a home before the academy existed.



the salon

paris, 1700s

where conversations that built the enlightenment happened in living rooms.



harlem renaissance

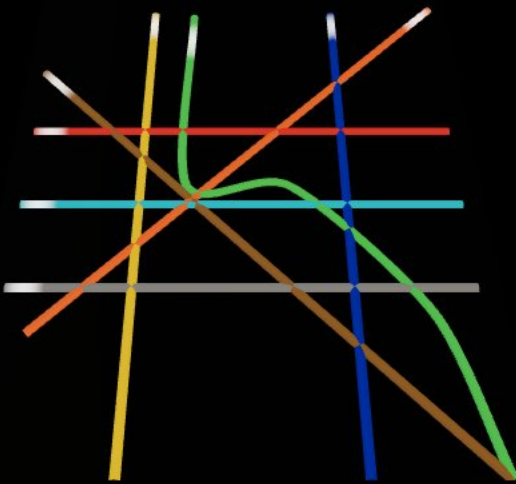
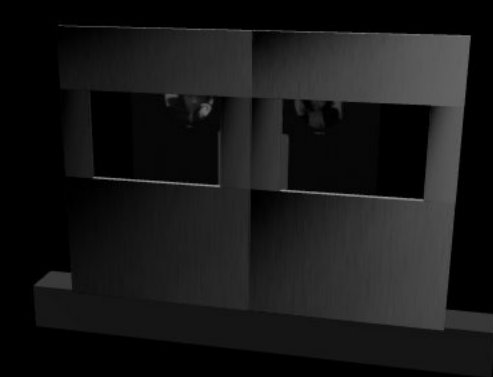
new york, 1920s

where Black intellectuals made space for possibility in the midst of danger.

what about now?

we're the new underground.

how it works



01
underground

where you become dangerous.

swipe in. pick a route. uncover a living world of buried artifacts, and suppressed ideas. your cyphcard maps how you think over time.



tap irl books, ideas & artifacts with cyphcard in apple wallet.



how it works



02

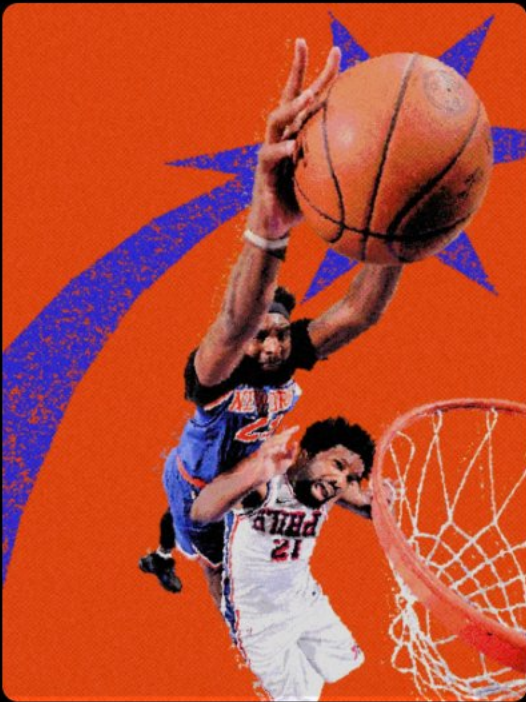
cyph

where ideas get tested in real time.

contest ideas in real-time cyphs with thinkers around the world. go deeper in office hours with the underground's sharpest scholars.

live

topics sourced from API's & real-time listening.



knicks championship



"shut up and dribble:" power in the nba
hosted by chris robinson

cyph types

- open mics
- supper clubs
- debates
- office hours

conceptual

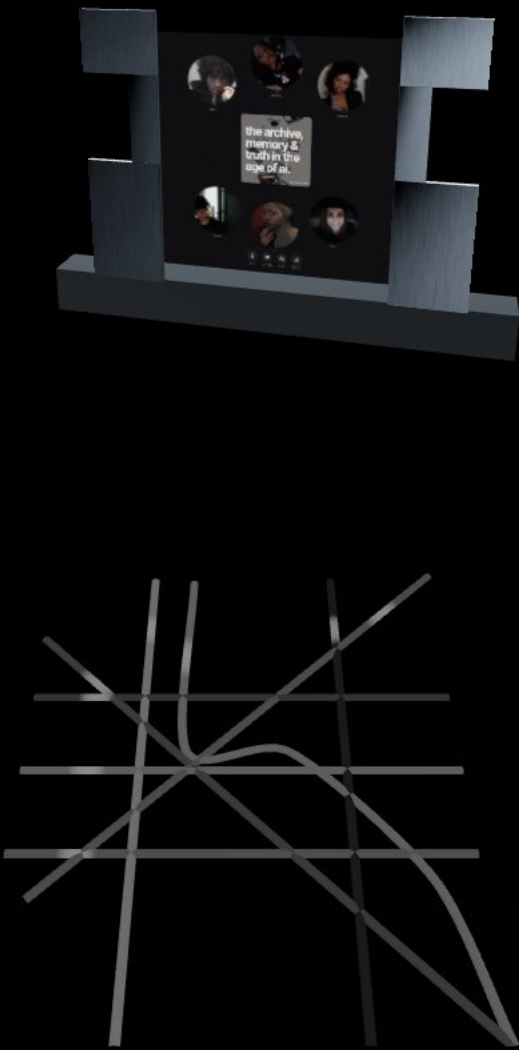
ideas surfaced from pulses in deep research.



is the soul actually cartesian?



the ghost was never in the machine
hosted by iain mcgilchrist



how it works



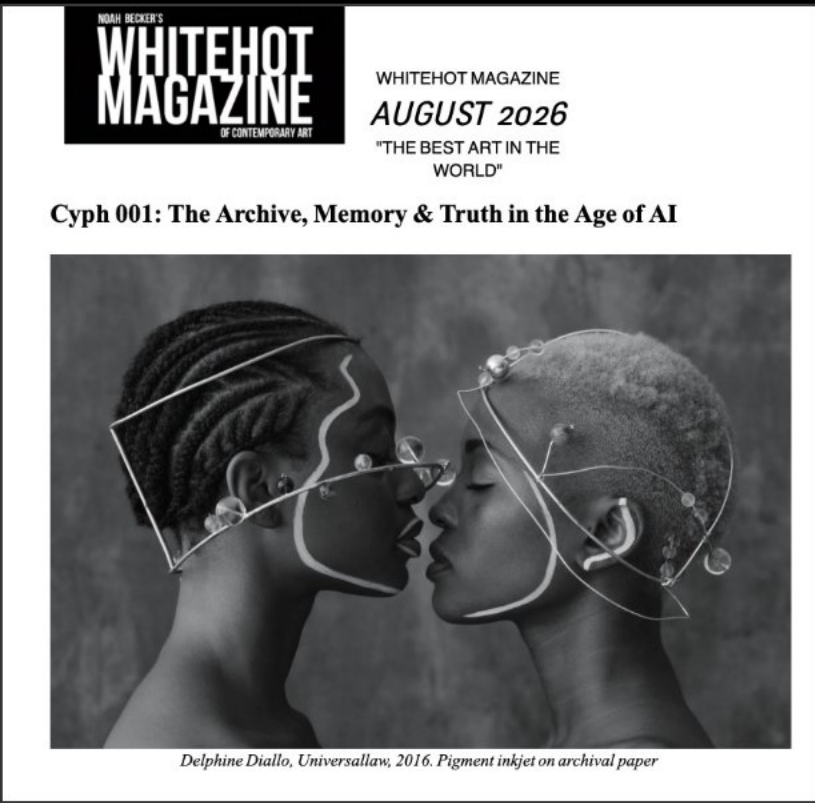
03

irl

no more screen addiction. close the laptop and enter our world of IRL lectures, office hours, supper clubs, & debates.

the research from the room is archived in our partner libraries.

our last cyph...



in the room



40+ residencies and venues across nyc.

underground thinkers want to work with us.

we've acquired over **11K**
personal artifacts from
historic legends.

seeded with rich culture & academia



all resources are **human-produced.** never ai slop.

how we make money.

cyphcard+

members pay annually for cohorts and rare perks, like residential libraries.



cyph.edu

universities license a students-only underground shared across sister campuses.



ads

resonant partners pay for placements across cyph city.



cyph scales to ~\$95M revenue by 2030 at ~72.5% gross margins...while keeping wisdom free for every user.

projections available upon request.

user behavior size.

	tam	sam	som
   seekers people who actively pursue depth, not just content consumption. <i>(i.e. rabbit-hole divers, obsessive researchers)</i>	2B	400M	15M
   sparrers people who enjoy testing ideas publicly and engaging in debate. <i>(i.e. sport fans, pop culture enthusiasts)</i>	1.5B	250M	12M
   "authorities" people with earned knowledge who want distribution + engagement beyond their niche. <i>(i.e. substack essayists, new school professors)</i>	300M	50M	4M

cyph is the first place where **seeking**, **sparring**, and **intellectual authority** live together.

note: behaviors are not mutually exclusive. breakdown available per request.

gtm.



founder promo

promote unique founder story, philosophy, and mission to make intellectual courage cool again.

upcoming podcasts, publications, video series, press, public service.



inventory stack

volumize our inventory with niche collaborators.

strategic announcements generate excitement for what's to come



dr. cornel west professor jiang

office hours

announce office hour lineups to pull in niche, high-volume audiences.



irl to url

convert IRL participants into URL evangelists.

build fomo thru movement building (e.g., lectures, debates, screenings, research hackathons, parties, supper clubs)

what real peeps have said.

"people are yearning to break the shackles and speak their truth."

"it encourages individuality...there's no need for an echo chamber."

"i like that it's centered around topics and things that matter rather than a sea of content."

"i love cyph because I can find actual scholars whom i would want to talk with."

"i've been craving a place to actually talk to people after an episode of [my favorite show]."

"this is like a digital tailgate!"

"humanity needs a platform that tells them to go outside."

"the internet was built to enable resource sharing and open communication, not to suppress them."

"the world needs an ed-tech platform built by someone who knows how to resonate with culture."

"this feels like a breath of fresh air. online today is extremely gimmicky."

the raise.

\$1.25M

raising

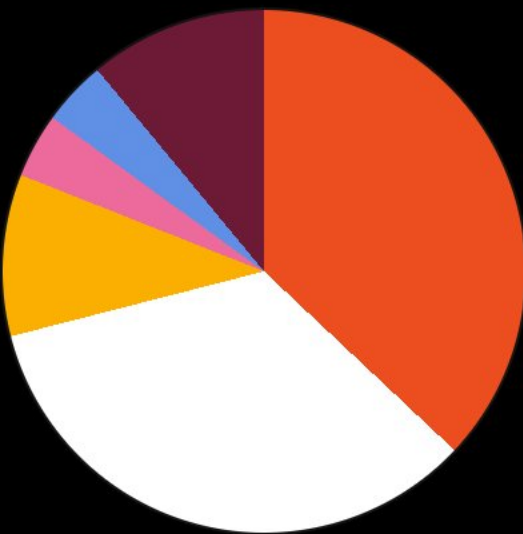
\$11.25M

pre-money cap

15 mo

runway

use of funds



- 37%

ops team
3 FTEs
- 34%

eng team
2 FTEs
- 10%

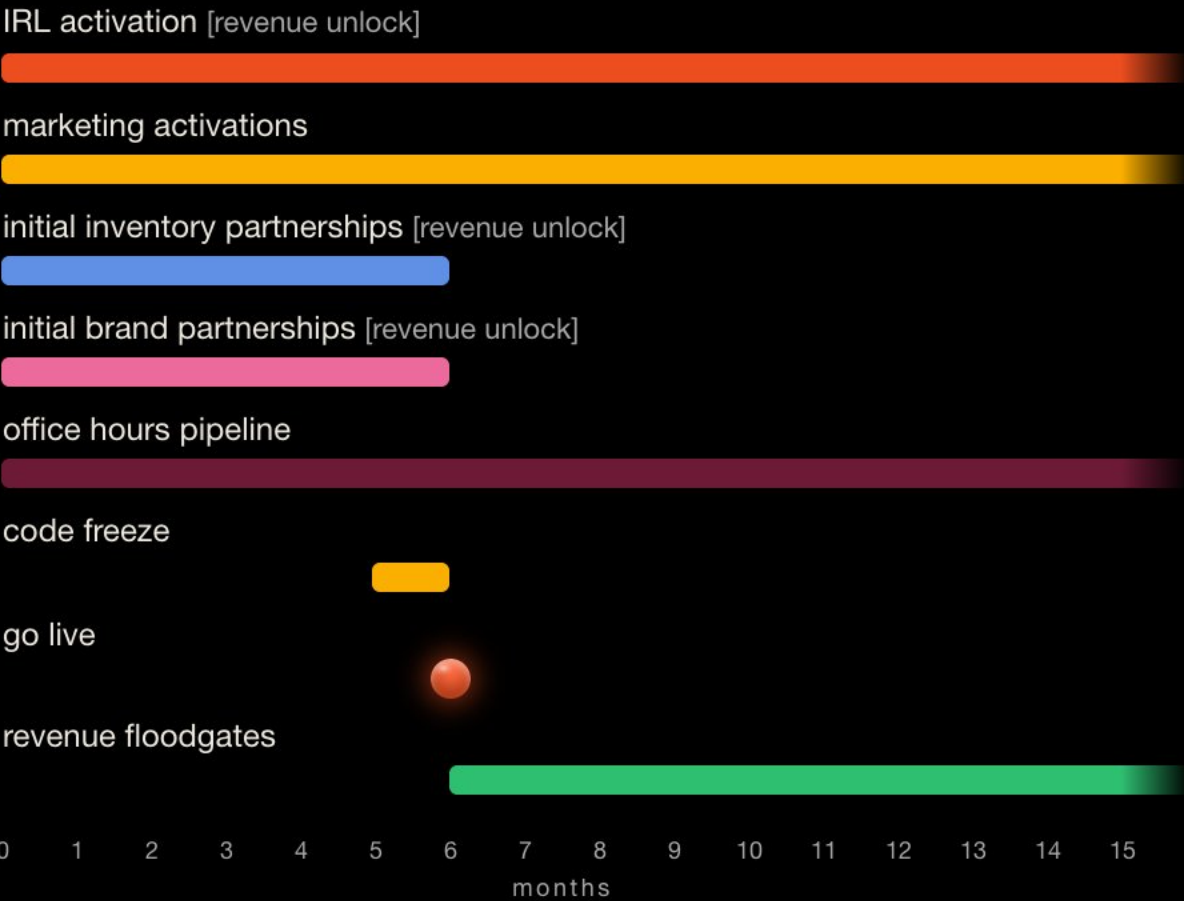
marketing & IRL
- 4%

overhead
- 4%

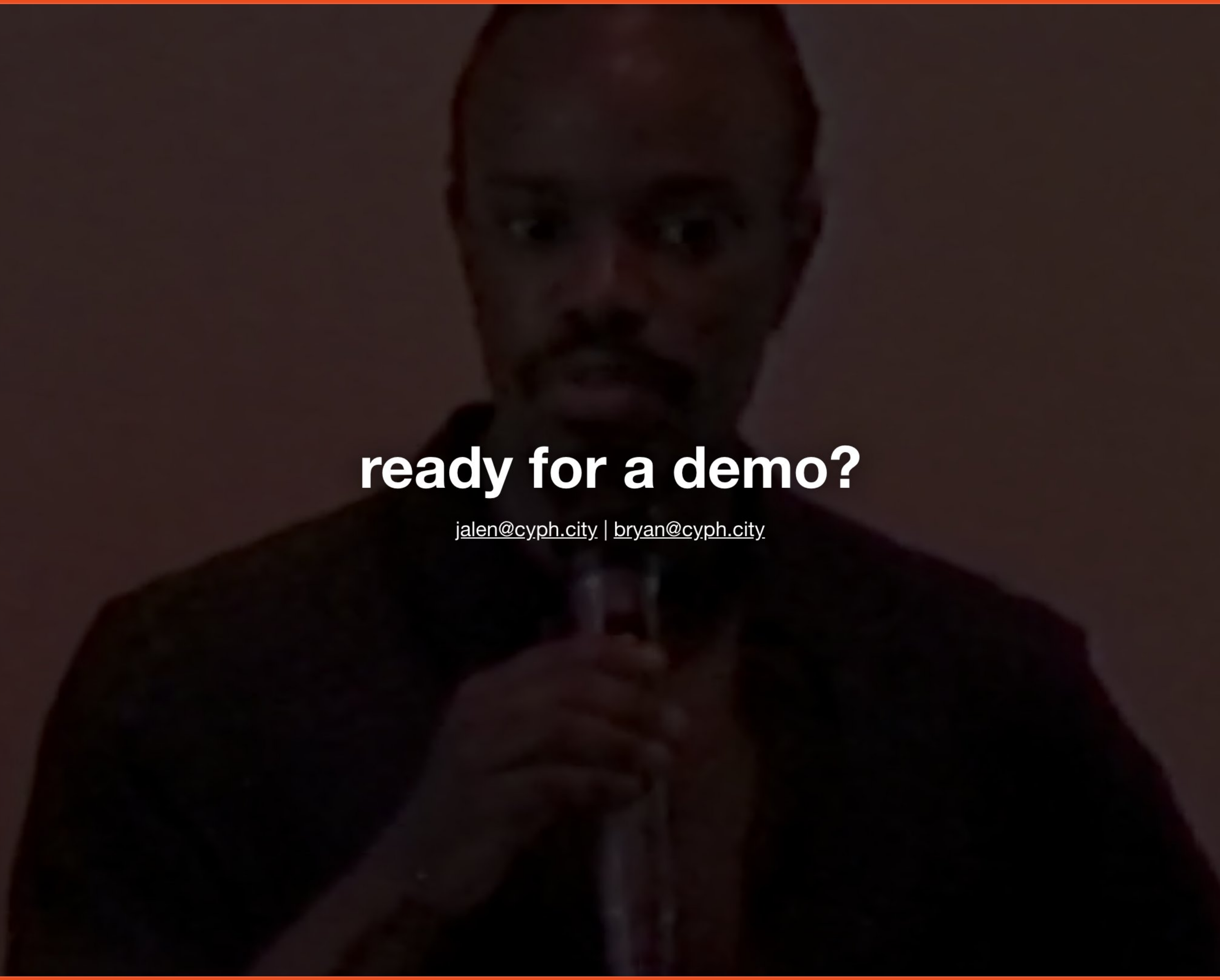
tech infra
- 11%

contingency

timeline



detailed model available upon request.



ready for a demo?

jalen@cyph.city | bryan@cyph.city



jalen daniels

I'm a native New Yorker and former classical ballerina. I trained for 14+ years and have performed everywhere from the Apollo Theater to the Supreme Court and the White House. At Harvard, I honed my intellectual edge through a dual honors concentration in Social Studies and African American Studies. My summa award-winning thesis, "Enemies of The New: Transhumanism, Blackness, and Fleshless Imaginaries," intervenes in the evolving conversation on race, humanity, and technology and is now moving toward publication.

After college, I worked at McKinsey & Co., focusing on entertainment, Web3/Crypto, and economic mobility; I ended my time working on the Firm's first documentary film that premiered at Martha's Vineyard Film Festival. I then served as Chief of Staff at an art and technology startup, which had partnerships with Sotheby's, OpenAI, the Brooklyn Museum, Spotify, and more.

Today, my work sits at the intersection of culture, ideas, and institutional imagination. I serve as the youngest Trustee in the history of the Harvard Club of New York City, where I focus on revitalizing innovation and bringing world-class speakers with provoking ideas. I am grateful to be the Strategic Lead of an emerging private school in Houston (\$65M raise) with a rich curriculum in Black Diasporic identity and theology. I have advised copious Fortune 500 companies, and I am a consultant on some of the most exciting brands, including some stealth startups started by ex TIME and GQ executives. In my free time, I host public speaking engagements on technology, theology, and philosophy.



**bryan
cash**

I'm a born-and-raised New Yorker and lifelong sports junkie—a kid from Jamaica, Queens who was obsessed with box scores, improbable correlations, and the energy of people. I've always seen the world through data long before it was a buzzword. I was the kid fascinated by how fast the NBA could aggregate Dwyane Wade's performance based on Gabrielle Union's attendance. That curiosity is what led me to study Computer Science at Syracuse. I wanted to help businesses uncover deep analytics that unlock real storytelling.

My career has always lived at the intersection of data and real-world impact. I audited multi-billion-dollar settlements, including the Volkswagen emissions scandal; rebuilt the analytics backbone for The Washington Post's Publishing & Circulation team; and helped scale Vantage Risk's Political, Risk & Credit unit from \$70M to over \$225M in Gross Written Premium (GWP), contributing to the firm surpassing \$1B+ GWP. While compelled by the power of data across these experiences, I wanted to bring my technology journey full circle and build platforms with cultural resonance.

I created my own sports analytics company, delivering proprietary data you couldn't find anywhere else. I then became CTO of an art and technology startup, which had partnerships with major institutions such as Sotheby's, Spotify, OpenAI, the Brooklyn Museum, and more.

Today, my work blends engineering rigor with cultural intuition, and is always driven by the belief that technology should amplify our humanity, not replace it. That's why we started Cyph.